

About Me Worksheet

People who are willing to share their life's story with others often find that this simple approach has powerful results. These short biographical sketches help associates and subordinates understand the leader's background and "where they are coming from." These sketches also tend to be easy to remember and strong communicators of the story teller's basic beliefs. This assignment is designed to help you clarify your story and has three parts.

- 1- Write your life story in 400 words or less. This word limit will require you to condense, focusing on the highlights and major events.

- a. **Who are you?** Introduce yourself by providing your name, program, background, interests and hobbies, and what is unique about you (consider your strengths and unique talents).

My name is Stefan Milinovic, and I am Software Engineering student at York University. My interests are in video games and nature, taking a beautiful world as inspiration to make incredible video games. I come from a background of music and dance, which helps me be more creative in my ideas and in the way I portray myself through my work in school and at home. Having played video games in my childhood, I understand what it is capable of and how moving they can be. My biggest strength comes from my ability to come up with ideas that I wish to then take and create games that tell a story and inspire others.

- b. **Where are you from?** Talk about where you grew up. What was it like? How did it help shape you into the kind of person you are today?

I grew up in an apartment in Toronto, similar to where I live today with my parents, sister, and my aunt. It was always busy in the house with people talking, eating, or watching movies. Even though I tend to keep to my self in the house, I never shy away from being with others, whether it is to play sports or go for a walk or just to hangout in the house. The support from the people closest to me in my life kept me motivated to do something that will make them proud and that will make the lives of the people around me and others better. Inspiring others to do the same.

- c. **Your York U Journey.** Why did you decide to attend York University? Why did you decide to enroll into the Lassonde Engineering program? What compelled you to choose your discipline (i.e. software, electrical, etc.). What current strengths do you have that will help you be successful at York?

York University was never my first choice, but it ended up being the only school that I had applied to that had accepted me for Software Engineering. At first I was disappointed in myself for what had happened, but through my years at York University I had then realized how much better this path in life ended up being. It was the only school from what I had applied to that would've kept me close to home and to the people that I care most about. And it is they who then inspire me to work harder than I would have alone elsewhere at a different university. Initially I had chosen software engineering for my interest in its different

real-world applications, specifically commercial applications that make all the difference in the world today. But since then, I have shifted to a more creative mindset, keeping with the same software interest, but more towards my interest in video games and how they too can make all the difference in the world today. This curiosity, inspiration, and motivation are what drive me to be disciplined and dedicated to the work I produce, so that I can always look back and be proud of what I had accomplished and what it has done for others and myself.

- d. **Your Inspiration.** Who is your favourite of all time inspiring teacher (from early childhood, parent, grandparent, teacher, etc.)? What attributes did this “teacher” have that you admired and still admire now? What did you learn from them?

My girlfriend is one of my biggest inspirations. Her positive attitude towards life and the people around her is what I try to be every single day. It is she that encourages me to take risks and try things I wouldn't have. Her support in my work and in my interests are what inspire me to never give up and to always keep pushing forward

- e. **Curate an Artifact.** Curate and insert an artifact that supports your About Me reflection. It may be a photo that captures the essence of who you are. It may be an image that captures an experience, interest, hobby and/or passion that has inspired you. Or it may be a favourite quote, song, movie or piece of art that has impacted you in some way.



- f. **Explanation of Artifact.** Explain the artifact you have selected to represent your About Me profile. Discuss the artifact, why you have selected it and how it represents who you are.

The artifact is a thumbnail that comes from the game Clair Obscur Expedition 33. I had chosen it as my artifact because it was one of the more recent games that I had played, and from all the games that I have ever played, this one left the biggest impact on me. From the story to the beautiful visuals and music, every

piece of this game works together to make one of the greatest digital experiences of today. A game that had won Game of the Year for 2025 from a team with only 30 people, a group who were very passionate about making a game that would leave a lasting impact. Their story, and many others, is what tells me that anything is possible, there is no limit to creativity and what it can do change the lives of others for the better. I was never more motivated from then on, to make a game that could leave an impact as big as theirs did, for years to come.

Part 1 – Life Story (400 words):

My name is Stefan Milinovic, and I am a Software Engineering student at York University. I grew up in a vibrant, bustling apartment in Toronto, surrounded by my parents, sister, and aunt. Though I often kept to myself, the constant energy of a house filled with conversation and movies taught me never to shy away from others, whether through sports or simply hanging out. This foundation of support from those closest to me is my primary motivator; I strive to make them proud and improve the lives of those around me.

My creative identity is rooted in music and dance, which allows me to bring a unique perspective to my technical work. Growing up with video games, I witnessed their power to move people and tell profound stories. While my technical interest initially focused on commercial applications, my time at York has shifted my mindset toward game development. I view the beautiful world around us as inspiration to create incredible games that can truly make a difference.

York University was not my first choice, and initially, being accepted only there felt like a disappointment. However, I soon realized that this path was exactly where I needed to be. It kept me close to my support system, and it is their presence that inspires me to work harder than I ever could have on my own. My curiosity and dedication are driven by a desire to look back on my work with pride, knowing it has served both others and myself.

My biggest inspiration is my girlfriend. Her positive attitude and willingness to take risks encourage me to push past my own boundaries and never give up. Together, these experiences have shaped me into a disciplined, creative engineer determined to inspire others through the intersection of software and storytelling.

- 2- In the table below, list the key events you mentioned in the 400 word story in the left column, on event per row. Then note the extent to which each event was an emotional up and down or whether it was neutral. Then try to summarize the key learning from that event in the third column. How did this experience shape your life? What did it teach you? What did you learn from each experience about leadership? How did this event contribute to your current self?**

Key Event	Emotional Impact (+5 to 0 to -5)	Key Learning or Insight
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1. Growing up in a busy Toronto household	+3	Importance of community and support
2. Being accepted only to York University	-3	Initially felt like a failure, but it taught me resilience
3. Realizing the value of staying close to home	+4	Learned that your environment influences motivation
4. Shifting focus from commercial apps to games	+5	Passion drives better discipline and results

3- Using the chart that follows, chart the key events in your life in terms of their emotional height, chronologically from left to right. Then, label the peaks and valleys with the events they represent.

- a. Your primary use for being clear about your life's major events and their impact on your leadership beliefs will be at various times and place in the future when you need to connect with people and let them know why you believe what you do and where your motivation come from.

+5	4.
	3.
	1.
0	
	2.
-5	

Time ->